

TAB 8



Board of Education Report

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File #: Res-022-22/23, Version: 1

Ms. Goldberg - Pencils Down: Resolution in Support of Writers Guild of America Members Striking to Secure a Just Contract and Safeguard the Future of their Profession (Res-022-22/23) (Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, The members of the Writers Guild of America West and the Writers Guild of America East (jointly WGA), labor unions that represent over 11,500 writers in film and television, officially called a strike on May 1, 2023;

Whereas, Writers are facing the most comprehensive assault on compensation and working conditions that they have seen in a generation, fighting for their livelihoods and the future of their profession, in an industry that is changing rapidly due to corporate consolidation, the rise of streaming services, the “gig-ification” of screen-writing, and the rise of artificial intelligence;

Whereas, Inflation-adjusted pay for writers has declined considerably over the last ten years, and fully 50% of writers are working at the minimum allowable pay, up from 33% ten years ago;

Whereas, Previous WGA strikes in 1960, 1981, 1985, 1988, and 2007 have secured for writers wage increases, residual pay, pensions, health care, and other benefits, and have allowed the profession to adjust to major changes in film and television production, media technology, and industry ownership, making screenwriting a viable career for many thousands of writers, instead of a precarious dead-end job;

Whereas, The operating profits of major networks and streaming companies including Disney, Netflix, Warner Bros, Fox, Comcast, Amazon, and Paramount have been close to \$30 billion year after year, and entertainment executives have a duty to share the wealth that writers create for them; and

Whereas, Film and television production is a major pillar of the regional economy, creating thousands of jobs for caterers, costume and set designers, prop workers, camera operators, animators, hair stylists and make-up artists, construction workers, drivers, grips, musicians, retail workers, hotel workers, restaurant workers, and countless others, and the 2007 WGA strike was estimated to have cost the local economy \$2.1 billion; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District supports the striking writers of the WGA;

Resolved further, That the Board calls on the Alliance of Motion Picture and Television Producers (AMPTP) to prepare a response to WGA demands that justifies a return to the bargaining table, an end to the strike, and leads to a just contract; and, be it finally

Resolved, That recognizing the possibility of a prolonged strike that leads WGA to call for a boycott or other actions in solidarity with striking writers, the Board directs the Procurement Services Division to prepare a report that describes any and all contracts, subscriptions, or other business between Los Angeles Unified School District and AMPTP members.